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MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM
MGU-UGP (HONOURS) REGULAR EXAMINATION March 2026
Fourth SEMESTER
Discipline Specific Elective (DSE) - MG4DSEENG200 – READING MALAYALAM CINEMA
(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration:2 Hours **Maximum Marks: 70**

Scheme of Valuation
Part A: MCQ
Answer all questions. Each question carries 1 mark

1. c. 1957 [K]/(CO1)
2. a. Sreenivasan [K]/(CO1)
3. b. symbol of family tradition [U]/(CO2)
4. b. modernising mythic figures [U]/(CO2)
5. d. blending reality and fictional layers [U]/(CO3)
6. a. M T Vasudevan Nair [K]/(CO4)
7. b. it shapes cultural attitudes toward the community [An]/(CO4)
8. d. Reflects changing cultural and social identities of urban men [U]/(CO4)
9. a. A specific historical context of scrutiny [An]/(CO4)
10. a. Serve as a mirror that allows audiences to identify with both the hero and their own sense of otherness [K]/(CO4)

[1x10 = 10]

Part B: SHORT ANSWER
Answer any 6 questions. Each question carries 5 marks

11. socio political context, social reforms, left ideology, class consciousness, democratisation and modernisation. *Neelakuyil, Chemmeen, Swayamvaram, Thampu, Kadavu, Nirmalyam,* etc. [An]/(CO1)
12. Sreedevi is the opposite of Ganga, village raised, believes in traditions and superstitions, obeys customs, confined to the Meda; while Ganga is city bred, inquisitive, disobeys. Nagavalli is an extension of Ganga rather than an opposite, one who transcends Ganga's limits, she appears contrary but really is a complimentary aspect of Ganga [E]/(CO2)
13. Tragedy in *Lekhayude Maranam* is an attempt to evoke people's memory of Shobha's death and also a technique to bring in realism, reflexivity as a narrative technique, double mystification of truth and "real" always have to be tragic [U]/(CO3)
14. The contrast between moral values and empirical truth is evident in *Drishyam*. The degeneracy of Varun is an excuse to forgive the crime of murder by Georgekutty. He is still the "common man" even after he deceives all the people. The popular perception of failure of state machinery and fall of moral order are exalted than facts and data [K]/(CO4)
15. Judith Butler, Eve Sedgwick, Laura Mulvey [K]/(CO4)
16. The central plot of the 1999 film *Vanaprastham* revolves around Kunhikuttan (played by Mohanlal), a renowned yet low-caste Kathakali artist in 1950s Kerala who struggles with issues of social status, personal identity and unrequited love.

The film follows his complex relationship with Subhadra (Suhasini), an upper-caste woman who falls in love with the stage persona of Arjuna that Kunhikuttan plays, rather than the man himself [U]/(CO4)

17. By failing to depict friction, instability or social resistance in Priyanka's domestic life, the film *Aalorukkam* minimises the real-world challenges faced by trans people in forming families and gaining social acceptance [An]/(CO4)
18. *Amen* skillfully blends the stylistic tenets of magical realism with the rooted traditions of Kerala's local folklore and Nasrani (Syrian Christian) culture. Set in the mythical village of Kumarankari, the film creates an ethereal, "dreamy" atmosphere where the supernatural is integrated into the daily lives of the villagers as a matter-of-fact reality. The intervention of the divine, the portrayal of St. George, etc are some of the elements of magic realism [A]/(CO4)
19. *Maheshinte Prathikaaram* (2016) follows Mahesh Bhavana, a calm small-town photographer in Idukki, who is humiliated and beaten in a street fight while trying to help a friend. Vowing not to wear footwear until he avenges the beating, the film focuses on his personal transformation, growth in his profession, and eventual emotional reconciliation with his attacker [U]/(CO4)

[5x6 = 30]

Part C: ESSAY
Answer any 2 questions. Each question carries 15 marks

20. The film *Swaroopam* (1992) is a sombre character study on how a sudden, misplaced pride in a romanticized, "imagined" past can destroy a perfectly functional present, turning a responsible man (the protagonist, Sekharan) into a delusional, irresponsible figure. The film serves as a psychological and social critique of how nostalgia, elite delusions, and the pursuit of "imagined" ancestral glory can destroy practical, hardworking lives. [E]/(CO1)
21. Ganga's transformation into Nagavalli in the 1993 film *Manichitrathazhu* suggests that memory is a malleable, often dangerous reservoir of unprocessed trauma; that identity is fragile and constructed through personal and cultural narratives; and that inherited stories, particularly feudal tales of oppression and gendered violence, can exert a heavy, triggering burden on the modern, psychological self. [An]/(CO2)
22. Dr. Biju's *Perariyathavar* (2015) is a significant piece of Malayalam "eco-social realism" that functions simultaneously as a poignant ecological film and a scathing political critique of caste in India. By focusing on the lives of two municipal sweepers, a temporary cleaner and his child, the film highlights the invisibility of marginalized labourers and the environmental degradation they are forced to inhabit. The inseparability of waste and marginalisation, caste and labour, state apathy, displacement all become themes. [E]/(CO3)
23. Drishyam is a powerful visualization of the conflict between the state, represented by the police and legal system and the public, represented by an ordinary citizen fighting for his family's survival. The film operates as a cat-and-mouse game that highlights the power dynamics between institutional authority and individual, resourcefulness, shifting the traditional perspective of "justice" to a, often legally ambiguous, moral ground. It caters to the public notion that state machinery is failing and it is up to the individual to uphold justice and moral order. [An] (CO 4)

[15x2 = 30]